

July 8, 2021

SIFA - Skills Initiative For Africa Report

The *Skills Initiative for Africa* (SIFA) is a proposed solution made by the African Union Commission and the German Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development to the increasing rate of youth unemployment across Africa. The initiative plans to fund skill development programs to train African youth in employable skills that align with the current labour-market needs in collaboration with private sector companies.

This initiative is composed of three parts: The SIFA FC, which is the financial facility, the SIFA TC which is the technical component and the ATVET4W which is Agricultural Technical Vocational Education and Training for Women.

SIFA FC controls the financial aspect of the skill development programs, SIFA TC focuses on skill development training that addresses job market needs through collaboration with the private sector. ATVET4W examines the relationship between job creation and agriculture.

The SIFA - FC, Financing Facility for Skills Development, grants funding on a 'competitive basis' through 'Funding Windows'. This component of SIFA is centred on initiatives that have training organizations collaborating with private sector companies to develop employable skills amongst youth.

In order to apply for Funding 'Window I', projects are required to operate over 36-40 months in which a training centre (lead) pairs up with at most 2 partners, one of which must be a private sector company, to improve access to skills development and employment opportunities.